some *Puranas*, are not ***pramanas*** because they do not bear directly on something that would otherwise be unknown.

Further reading: Halbfass 1991

Shunya (emptiness): ***Nagarjuna*** draws out the philosophical implications of the idea frequently expressed in the early *Mahayana* Buddhist 'Perfection of Wisdom' (*Prajnaparamita*) literature that everything is empty. He interprets this as meaning that nothing whatsoever has an essential, unchanging nature (***svabhava***) because the very notion is an impossible one. There are no real essences because essence means immutable nature and something with an immutable nature cannot participate in a process of change. That there are no essences extends to the basic mental and material atomic factors (***dharma***) that the ***Abhidharma*** Buddhists hypothesized as the ultimately real building blocks of the cosmos. ***Dharmas*** + ***svabhava*** = static reality. 'Emptiness' does not mean the same as 'interdependent origination' (***pratitya-samutpada***) because the basic atomic factors are not dependently originated, conditioned (*samskrita*) realities. To say that the ***dharmas*** lack essence is to reject the realist's requirement that there are ultimate facts that are mind-independent, that is, not conceptually constructed. To say that all things are empty of essential nature is to say that there are no classes or types of entities. In short, there are no real entities.

Nothing can be self-created or self-existent; nothing is entirely self-sufficient and independent of other things. The notion of immutable timeless essences makes no sense. Moreover, anything that arises in dependence of cause and conditions is also devoid of essential nature and is conceptually constructed.

The mere fact of its being caused does not entail that something lacks essence. What is incompatible with the